Entry 3 · Reading · First created: 14 Nov 2026 · Last amended: 14 Nov 2026

E3 Reading – ESB Set L Full Paper, then Linking Words and Main Idea – Day Plan and Answers

Scheme week 11 · because, so, although, however · main idea and supporting detail · online dictionaries · ESB criteria AC1.1–AC4.1 (Set L)

Print: you have already printed the print pack (day plan + 21 × Set L Tasks 1–2). Print the top-up file once, double-sided: this day plan + 21 × the Task 3 sheet. Nothing else.

Prep: none beyond printing. Before 12:30 log the PCs in and post the afternoon lesson link in Teams General. Nothing to cut out.

Project: Morning – Set L Full Paper projector page (6 pages). Afternoon, PC room – Linking Words lesson page (9 pages): open it in teacher mode (press T, or add ?teacher to the link); learners open the same link from Teams and see the same page numbers.

Why this plan: on Wed 11 Nov the class covered the time-order and alphabetical-order teaching. The Set L paper was not sat, so the morning is the whole paper exactly as in the exam (3 texts, 21 questions, 60 minutes). The afternoon starts scheme week 11. The week's Kahoot (Set L revision, ready in Kahoot) moves to Wednesday.

Morning, classroom – the full Set L paper under exam conditions (about 9:40–11:45)

Time	Activity and aim	Resource	What to say (and do)	Learners do	Grouping	Answers / check
9:40 (10)	Exam routine. Aim: work the way you will in the real exam.	AM page 1 (My exam routine) Set L Tasks 1–2 + Task 3 sheet	"Today is a real exam paper. Desks apart. Phones away. No talking. Blue or black pen." Read the five steps with the class. "You lose no marks for a wrong answer, so never leave a question blank. Today is exactly like the exam: three texts, 21 questions, 60 minutes – about 20 minutes for each text." Hand out Tasks 1–2 and the Task 3 sheet, face down. Write the finish time on the board.	Move desks apart; put phones away; say the routine back.	Whole class	Check: every learner has a pen, both papers face down, and can say the finish time.
9:50 (60)	Set L Tasks 1, 2 and 3, timed. Aim: finish a whole real paper in the time.	AM page 2 (60-minute timer) Set L papers	"Turn over your paper. You may start. Read the title and the first sentences first." Press Start. Do not help with words. Walk round; note who gets stuck and on which question. At 40:00 "Twenty minutes gone – you should be on Task 2." At 20:00 "Twenty minutes left – start Task 3 now." At 5:00 "Five minutes left. Answer every question." "Finished early? Write the line that proves each answer."	Work alone in silence; fast finishers write proof line numbers.	Alone	Listen for: nobody talking; everyone reaches Task 3. Note the questions most learners leave blank. **Do not cut this step.**

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10:50 (12)	Prove it: Task 1. Aim: every answer is proved from the text.	AM page 3 (Task 1 answers, one per click)	"Stop writing. Swap papers with your partner. Take a different colour pen. I ask for the answer. Then a different learner reads the words in the text that prove it." One learner answers, another reads the proof, then click Show next answer. Q3: "Who is 'they'? Singular or plural? Person or thing?" Q5: "Which wrong answer was tempting? Why is it wrong?"	Mark in a different colour; give answers and read the proof.	Pairs, then whole class	1 False 2 any two: houses / travel / living expenses are cheaper (in the north) 3 C Companies 4 B a list of questions 5 C reports 6 lower rent · staff more easily 7 fare, film, music, podcast
11:02 (12)	Prove it: Task 2. Aim: the same, for two letters.	AM page 4 (Task 2 answers)	The same routine – answer, proof, then click. Q10: "Who is 'I'? Look at the name at the end of the letter." Q12: "What is the purpose? Which words tell you?"	Mark; give answers and proof.	Pairs, then whole class	8 B wanting a job 9 Leeds 10 C James Turner 11 False 12 A offer an interview 13 Debbie Seymour 14 attend
11:14 (12)	Prove it: Task 3. Aim: the same, for a fact page.	AM page 5 (Task 3 answers)	The same routine. Q15: "Is the text only about growing mangoes? What else is it about?" Q17: "Why are there bullet points? What do they show?" Q21: "flavour, fresh – which comes first? Look at the second letter." "Count the marks out of 21. Write the number at the top. Give the papers back." Hands up for each question; type the two weakest question numbers on page 6.	Mark; count the score out of 21.	Pairs, then whole class	15 False 16 green 17 C give a list 18 A tasty 19 C informs 20 any two: eye health · some cancers · blood pressure 21 B
11:26 (15)	Fix it and set a target. Aim: learners correct what they got wrong and see why.	AM page 6 · own marked paper	"Look at the questions you got wrong. Choose two. For each one, write the correct answer and the words in the text that prove it. Then tell your partner why the wrong answer was tempting." Read the proof sentence for the class's weakest question and ask: "Which words in the question are different from the words in the text?" "Write your score out of 21 and one target: Next time I will …" Hear three targets.	Correct two wrong answers with proof; write score and target.	Alone, then pairs	Check: two corrections with a line from the text, a score and a target. *If short of time: one correction each.*

Afternoon, PC room – Linking words: because, so, although, however · main idea and detail (about 12:30–2:30)

Time	Activity and aim	Resource	What to say (and do)	Learners do	Grouping	Answers / check
12:30 (10)	Which do you prefer – and why? Aim: give a reason with because.	PM page 1 (whole class) Lesson link posted in Teams	"Log in. While we wait, look at the board. Which do you prefer, the bus or a bike? … I prefer the bus because it is warm." Model with one learner, then pairs ask and answer all six. Late arrivals join a pair. "Today: four small words that join ideas – because, so, although, however. They are in every exam text."	Ask and answer in pairs.	Pairs	Listen for: because + a reason. Take three answers from the class.
12:40 (15)	Four words that join ideas. Aim: reason, result, surprise, different idea.	PM page 2 (whole class)	"'I was late because the bus did not come.' Which part is the reason? 'The bus did not come, so I was late.' Which part is the result?" "Although and however show a surprise or a different idea. Although is inside one sentence. However starts a new sentence, with a comma after it." Which word? – read each sentence with 'beep' for the gap; the class calls the word; a learner says the full sentence; then click.	Call the word; say the full sentence.	Whole class	so · Although · because · However · so · Although
12:55 (15)	Task A: choose the linking word (10). Aim: use the four words correctly.	PM page 3 (own PC)	"Go to page 3. Click the best word. Think first – you only get the point if your first click is right." Walk round. If a learner mixes although and however, ask: "One sentence or two? Is there a comma after the gap?" Check in teacher mode: Show next answer, one per click; a learner reads each full sentence.	Choose the word for 10 sentences.	Alone	1 because · 2 so · 3 Although · 4 However · 5 so · 6 because · 7 Although · 8 However · 9 so · 10 because
13:10 (20)	Task B: read and answer (8). Aim: main idea and details in an opinion text.	PM page 4 (own PC)	"Page 4. First read the title and the first sentence of each paragraph – our exam routine. Then read the whole text once. Then answer. The words in the questions are different from the words in the text." Do not explain words yet (Task E). Fast finishers: find the nine linking words and say what each one joins. Check: one per click; for each, a learner reads the words in the text that prove it.	Read; answer 8 questions.	Alone	1 longer opening hours for the library 2 at five in the afternoon 3 Evening opening would not be useful for Fatima. 4 before her midday meal 5 It is shut when he gets to college. 6 not big and not quiet 7 Longer hours would be more expensive. 8 Daniel

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13:30 (15)	Task C: main idea or detail? (10) Aim: tell a main point from a supporting detail.	PM page 5 (own PC; text on page 4)	“Every paragraph has one main idea – what it is about. The other sentences are details: small facts that help.” “Paragraph 3: ‘Daniel needs the library to open later’ – main idea. ‘Daniel works in a warehouse’ – a detail.” Check one per click; ask “Which paragraph? What is that paragraph about?” Then: “In the exam, ‘What is the main point?’ is this question.”	Sort 10 sentences.	Alone (pairs may talk)	1 main · 2 detail · 3 main · 4 detail · 5 main · 6 detail · 7 detail · 8 main · 9 detail · 10 detail
13:45 (15)	Task D: join the sentences (8). Aim: write sentences with the four words.	PM page 6 (own PC)	“Page 6. Join the two sentences with the word. Type your answer and click Check. With however keep two sentences and put a comma after However.” Model number 1 on the board. Walk round; look for ‘Although …, but …’ and ‘Because …, so …’ – two joining words for one job.	Type 8 joined sentences; two tries each.	Alone	1 The market is cheap, so many people shop there. 2 I was late because the bus did not come. 3 Although it was cold, we played football in the park. 4 The flat is near the station. However, it is very noisy. 5 She has two jobs, so she is always busy. 6 He walks to college because he wants to save money. 7 Although the shop is small, it is always full. 8 The course is free. However, you must buy your own books.
14:00 (12)	Task E: online dictionary (6). Aim: check a word’s meaning in context.	PM page 7 (own PC) Cambridge Dictionary (button on the page)	“Page 7. Six words from the text. Open the Cambridge Dictionary, type the word, read the meaning, then come back and choose the meaning that fits our text.” Model ‘opinion’ on the projector. “In the exam there is no dictionary – so after you check, read the sentence again and see how the words around it help.”	Look up 6 words; choose the meaning.	Alone	what a person thinks about something · a large building where goods are kept · the people who work in a place · full of loud sounds · you must pay more · very little sound

Time	Activity and aim	Resource	What to say (and do)	Learners do	Grouping	Answers / check
14:12 (12)	Task F: your opinion in Teams. Aim: four sentences with the four words.	PM page 8 Teams General	"Open Teams, General. Should the college library open in the evening? Four sentences – because, so, although and however, one time each. Then read two posts and reply to one: I agree because … or I disagree because …" Point at a wrong joining word and ask: "Reason, result or surprise?" – don't correct it for them. Pick two good posts to read aloud.	Write 4 sentences; reply to a classmate.	Alone, then reply	Check: each word used once, correctly; comma after However. *If short of time: three sentences, no reply.*
14:24 (8)	Find the mistake. Aim: fix the common errors.	PM page 9 (whole class)	"Eyes on the board. Each sentence has one mistake. Talk to your partner for 20 seconds." A learner says the correct sentence, then click. Read the two good Teams posts aloud. "Tell your partner one true sentence with although." "On Wednesday we use these words to find the main point in exam texts."	Correct each sentence aloud.	Pairs, then whole class	1 because I was ill 2 no 'but' after Although 3 However, + comma 4 no 'so' after Because 5 hungry, so he ate 6 new sentence: However, she …

Answers (teacher pages only)

Set L – one mark each; 2, 6 and 20 need both reasons. Marks out of 21. Task 1: 1 False ("Travellers … feel the train fares are too high"). 2 any two: houses are cheaper; travel is cheaper; day-to-day living expenses are cheaper in the north. 3 C Companies. 4 B a list of questions. 5 C reports. 6 they pay lower rent; they get staff more easily. 7 fare, film, music, podcast.

Task 2: 8 B wanting a job. 9 Leeds ("when I moved to Leeds … I work in a newsagent shop at the moment"). 10 C James Turner. 11 False ("similar" means nearly the same). 12 A offer an interview. 13 Debbie Seymour. 14 attend.

Task 3: 15 False (it is about mangoes in general – where they come from, size, health benefits, preparation). 16 green. 17 C give a list. 18 A tasty. 19 C informs. 20 any two: improve eye health; protect against some cancers; help to control blood pressure. 21 B (flavour, fresh, season, smooth).

Afternoon text – Should the college library open in the evening? (on PM page 4) Paragraph main ideas: 1 some learners want later opening; 2 evening opening would not help Fatima; 3 Daniel needs later opening; 4 later opening is hard for the college (cost, staff).

Task A: 1 because · 2 so · 3 Although · 4 However · 5 so · 6 because · 7 Although · 8 However · 9 so · 10 because

Task B: 1 longer opening hours for the library · 2 at five in the afternoon · 3 Evening opening would not be useful for Fatima. · 4 before her midday meal · 5 It is shut when he gets to college. · 6 not big and not quiet · 7 Longer hours would be more expensive. · 8 Daniel

Task C: 1 main · 2 detail · 3 main · 4 detail · 5 main · 6 detail · 7 detail · 8 main · 9 detail · 10 detail

Task D: 1 The market is cheap, so many people shop there. · 2 I was late because the bus did not come. · 3 Although it was cold, we played football in the park. · 4 The flat is near the station. However, it is very noisy. · 5 She has two jobs, so she is always busy. · 6 He walks to college because he wants to save money. · 7 Although the shop is small, it is always full. · 8 The course is free. However, you must buy your own books. (the page also accepts 'Because …, …' and '… although …' orders).

Task E: what a person thinks about something · a large building where goods are kept · the people who work in a place · full of loud sounds · you must pay more · very little sound